

STEP by Step

STEP 1

Collection of list of colleges to be surveyed

A list of more than 1,500 colleges in the streams of arts, science, commerce, engineering, medicine and law was prepared using the existing list of colleges collated over a period of 13 years and through various secondary data sources like the Internet, published reports and the Association of Indian Universities Handbook. Even experts who assigned the rankings could suggest additions to the list.

STEP 2

Calculation of the parameter-wise ranks and the perceptual ranks at the city level

■ The respondents were first asked to rate the importance of each of the five parameters—reputation of colleges, quality of academic inputs, student care, infrastructure and job prospects. The importance for each parameter was then derived.

■ Experts were then asked to rate the performance (on a five-point scale) of colleges on these parameters based on their perception but were not allowed to rate their own colleges. In arts, science and commerce, 236 experts rated colleges only for their city. For engineering, medicine and law, 151 experts were asked to rate colleges for their respective zones (east, west, north and south).

■ Based on the ratings by experts, the performance of colleges was calculated. This score was derived by assigning weights to the levels of performance and multiplying them by the frequency of response. The performance score thus derived for each parameter was then multiplied with the importance of that parameter to get a perceptual score for it.

■ All the parameter scores were then added to arrive at the overall perceptual score of a college, on the basis of which we arrived at the perceptual ranking of the colleges.

STEP 3

Calculation of the parameter-wise ranks and the perceptual ranks at the national level

■ On the basis of step two, all colleges to be evaluated at the national level were tabulated. Another 396 experts then rated the colleges for all six streams, of whom 243 were then asked to rate the arts, science, commerce colleges from their city, barring those where they taught.

■ The same process was then used to arrive at the overall perceptual ranking of colleges at the national and the city levels. The overall perceptual ranking was obtained by combining the perceptual scores from step two and three. On the basis of the perceptual score of a parameter, the perceptual ranking for each parameter was arrived at.

STEP 4

Calculation of factual ranks

■ The perceptual scores at the national level formed the basis for colleges to be rated for factual ranking. The Top 50 colleges each for arts, science, commerce and the Top 25 for engineering, medicine and law were chosen.

■ On the basis of responses from the previous survey, weightage for each parameter for factual ranking was decided. The weighted response on each parameter was then added up to arrive at the overall factual score.

■ These factual scores thus formed the basis of arriving at the factual ranking.

STEP 5

Calculation of the final rank

■ The maximum overall perceptual score was rescaled to 100 and the perceptual scores of all colleges were apportioned to this maximum score. Similarly, the maximum overall factual score was rescaled to 100 and the factual scores of all colleges were apportioned to this maximum score.

■ Thus, the rescaled perceptual score and the factual score of a college were added in the ratio of 70:30 to arrive upon the final score. This score helped in tabulating the final national ranking of colleges.

college to get a higher score and hence produced a more robust sample of experts.

To determine the overall ranking, colleges that figured in Top 50 in the arts, science and commerce streams and Top 25 in the engineering, medicine and law streams were contacted for factual data. The colleges which declined to provide the factual data were not considered in

the final ranking process. All factual information related to a college was rescaled and then aggregated to get an overall factual score. To calculate the final overall score, a 70:30 weightage was then assigned to the perceptual and factual scores respectively. The methodology of ranking, based on both perceptual and factual data, provides a comprehensive picture of each college rated. ■